

lead

Good evening. My name is Monica Strauser, and I am a Kennett Township resident. "I request that the substance of my comments be reflected in the minutes, and I am providing my written remarks for the public record."

I am speaking tonight on behalf of a petition signed by **353 verified Township residents** asking the Board not to make another irreversible commitment to the municipal expansion project until the public planning is complete.

I want to thank Supervisor Bailey for acknowledging on June 17 that the Township needs a document explaining the rationale for current and future police staffing before the final building vote. He subsequently wrote that it should be completed within two to three months and presented at a future Board meeting.

That is meaningful progress. But a recommendation is not yet a Board commitment.

Residents still do not know exactly what the document will contain, whether the Board will vote on the police service and staffing plan, whether alternatives will be compared, or whether design, borrowing, bidding, and other project commitments may continue while that work is underway.

Tonight, residents have individual questions that remain unanswered: population assumptions, calls for service, staffing, the room-by-room program, smaller and phased alternatives, total financial consequences, and public participation.

Together, these are not separate objections. They are the elements of one responsible decision-making process.

I therefore ask Supervisor Bailey—or another member of the Board—to make a motion directing the Township Manager to prepare and publish a **Police Facility Transparency and Strategic Plan**, including:

1. a Board-approved police service and staffing strategy;
2. population, housing, workload and financial projections;
3. a room-by-room space justification;
4. reduced-scope and phased alternatives with full lifecycle costs; and
5. a dedicated public work session.

The motion should also state that the Board will not authorize construction bids, borrowing, or another irreversible phase until that information has been presented publicly and considered by the Board. A motion matters because it establishes exactly what must be produced, who is responsible for producing it, and when the public will receive it. It also gives all three supervisors an opportunity to state clearly whether they support this process.

We support correcting the deficiencies in the police facility. But the order matters: **decide the service model, establish the need, compare the alternatives, understand the cost—and then approve the building.**

Supervisor Bailey has recommended that a staffing-rationale document be completed before the final building vote. I appreciate that recommendation. Now I ask the Board to turn it into an enforceable public commitment.

Please make the motion tonight—or place it on the next agenda for a public vote.

3. What police service model is right for Kennett Township?

Good evening. My name is _____, and I live at _____.

Before deciding how large a police building should be, the Board must decide what police service model the Township intends to provide.

Will Kennett maintain its current coverage arrangement? Move toward 24-hour local coverage? Add specialized units? Depend on regional partnerships? Expand supervisory or administrative staffing?

Reasonable people may support different answers. That is exactly why the choice must be made openly by the elected Board.

Each service model has different staffing, space and tax consequences. A building designed for one model may be oversized or inadequate for another.

I am not asking the Board tonight to choose less policing or more policing. I am asking you to define the service outcome first, evaluate its cost, and then design the facility needed to deliver it.

Please adopt and vote on that service model before approving the final building scope.

(optional: "I request that the substance of my comments be reflected in the minutes, and I am providing my written remarks for the public record.")